



Direct Help from Microsoft

Get professional help with XP. Go to **Start > Help** and click the Support button. It will give you access to help straight from Microsoft, provided you are connected to the Net.



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Increasing connection speed

Some of us may find that after installing Windows XP, the Internet connection gets slower. A possible reason for this is the QoS (Quality of Service) installed. This service reserves 20 per cent of the bandwidth for itself, even with QoS disabled. In order to remove this reserved quota, you will have to



make sure you are logged on as Administrator. Go to **Start > Run** and type **gpedit.msc**. Expand the 'local computer policy' branch, the 'administrative templates' branch, and the 'network' branch. Highlight the 'QoS Packet Scheduler' in the left window and in the right window double-click the 'limit reservable bandwidth' setting. Then, on the Setting tab, check the 'enabled' item and change the 'Bandwidth limit %' to read 0. After doing this, you should immediately notice a boost in your Internet connection speed.



Speeding up network browsing

A bug in Windows 2000 would cause the scheduled tasks folder to be searched whenever the user browses

network drives. While Microsoft has developed a fix for this bug, the fix slows down the browsing of Microsoft networks. In order to fix this problem, go to **Start > Run** and type in **regedit**. Navigate to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE/Software/Microsoft/Windows/Current Version/Explorer/RemoteComputer/NameSpace**. Then find a key named {D6277990-4C6A-11CF-8D87-00AA0060F5BF}. Right-click on it and delete it. Restart the computer and now you will be able to browse the network a lot faster.



Bridging connections

If you'd like to connect two or more computers via LAN, then you should utilise the Network Bridge option provided in Windows XP. There is no configuration required and you do not need to purchase additional hardware such as routers or bridges. IP addressing, address allocation, and name resolution is highly simplified in a single subnet IP network. To use this feature you will have to open Network Connections. Under LAN or High-Speed Internet, select each of the private network connections that you want to be part of the bridge. Right-click one of the highlighted private network connections and click Bridge Connections.

Troubleshooting Program Incompatibility

■ **Check the Internet for updates or fixes:** Check the Web site of the program's manufacturer to see if an update or patch is available. Refer to the Microsoft Windows Update Web site to see if a fix is available for the program.

■ **Use an Administrator Account to install the program:** Many programs must be installed by using an administrator account. This is because many programs were written for use with Windows 95, Windows 98, Windows 98 Second Edition, or Windows Millennium Edition

(Me). These operating systems did not have an administrator or limited user account.

■ **Log off all users except the account that will install the program:** The Fast User Switching feature is new to Windows XP and because of this, most older programs were not designed to support this feature. If you have multiple users logged on to the computer, log everyone off except the account that will install the program.

■ **Use the Program Compatibility Wizard:** You can

use the Program Compatibility Wizard to test your program in different modes (environments) and with various settings. For example, if the program was originally designed to run on Windows 95, set the compatibility mode to Windows 95 and try running your program again. If successful, the program will start in that mode each time. The wizard also prompts you to try different settings, such as switching the display to 256 colours and the screen resolution to 640 by 480 pixels.